



PROGRESS REPORT

Malawi: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-01 · 198 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY ·
INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-01.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	The President directed all agencies to digitalise passports, identity cards, licences and procurement, while a draft transformation strategy is still in validation under the 2023-28 digitalisation policy. The directive was given in the State of the Nation Address against a target of 80 per cent internet usage by 2026, with no baseline given against which it could be assessed (directive); of the four named services only public procurement is evidenced as delivered inside the window (directive). A draft national digital transformation strategy went to a validation workshop in February 2026 and remains pre-adoption (validation , consultations). The 2023-28 policy remains the reference framework, with the e-government department under pressure to onboard all agencies onto the service bus intended to let ministries exchange data (framework , implementation , enforcement). A national digital readiness assessment was published by the information and digitalisation ministry with development-partner support, covering digital public infrastructure - data exchange, payments and identification - alongside connectivity and its physical layer (assessment). The held capture carries its front matter and contents; its scores, recommendations and any commitment made against them are not read out here.	MIXED a presidential directive to digitalise four named services against a strategy still pre-adoption and a service bus that has never operated
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	Spectrum licence fees were cut by 20 per cent and the regulator is building a harmonised national broadband map under a regional project. The reduction across all bands followed review of the regulator's 2016 incentive pricing model; no fee schedule, gazette notice or statutory instrument is held, so the base amounts and the effective date are unknown (reduction , account). The minister told Parliament in July 2026 that the cut was 50 per cent (reduction); five contemporaneous accounts say 20 and no source records a second reduction (parliament). The regulator hosted a five-day training at Lilongwe in August 2026 for broadband-mapping practitioners from four countries, under a 2025-2028 project to establish harmonised national broadband mapping in eleven sub-Saharan regulators (mapping). The mapping system itself launched on 7 October 2025 with regulator, telecommunications-union and European Union support, against 4G coverage of 75 per cent and 18 per cent of the population actively using the internet in 2023 (launch). No map, dataset or publication address for it is held, so what it has produced is not established.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A draft National AI Strategy has been through validation and a citizen-feedback portal, guided by a readiness assessment validated in July 2026. Regional consultative workshops began in September 2025 and a two-day validation workshop was held in Lilongwe in February 2026; the strategy is pre-adoption with no adoption date on record (workshops , validation , assessment). The readiness assessment was validated in July 2026 to guide it, finding gaps in policy, infrastructure, institutional capacity and education readiness, with 27.7 per cent of the population online against household computer ownership of 4.2 per cent (readiness). It was run by the education ministry rather than the ICT ministry that owns the strategy (regional framework).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Act 2024 exempted most controllers for twenty-four months from commencement, and that exemption elapsed in early June 2026. The Act commenced in June 2024 with the regulator designated data protection authority, and exempted controllers and processors not of significant importance from compliance for twenty-four months, so most of the economy sat outside its obligations (Act). The general exemption elapsed in early June 2026 so that all controllers and processors are now within scope, while the subsidiary instruments to operate registration and enforcement were still in draft (compliance , terms of reference). The commencement day cannot be settled from this base: the circulating expiry date implies a 2 June 2024 commencement and the commencement notice is not held.	ADVANCED grace period elapsed
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The National Registration Act is under review and registration service fees were raised by regulations gazetted in July 2026. A consultative meeting under the acceleration project reviewed the registration Act and the marriage and family relations statute, the bureau stating the aim is a modern and secure civil registration and identification system; no bill, draft or timetable is on record (review). Amendment regulations gazetted on 31 July 2026 raised fees for identity card replacement, electronic know-your-customer verification, civil registration and marriage services; the individual levels and their previous values are not carried in the record held, so the size of the increase is not established, and the electronic verification charge is a charge on third parties for using the identity system (fees).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	A financial crimes amendment removing all references to cheques passed Parliament in August 2026, one of four bills effecting the cheque phase-out. The bill was passed alongside amendments to the payment systems and deposit insurance statutes, following a bills of exchange amendment that effects the phase-out (bills). Assent, gazette date and commencement are not published, and the safeguarding regulations the finance minister promised are not drafted. A member warned that rural users risk being left behind by the switch away from cheques (warning), and the base holds no primary for the discontinuation itself and no date for it.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	A proposed government data sharing regulation would route all data requests through the national data centre and require binding sharing agreements, and it is not made. Ministries and agencies had been sharing citizen data by email, USB drive and paper, and the platform operated without binding rules (regulation). The proposal would require encryption in transit and at rest, set a common digital standard for system-to-system exchange, and require binding data sharing agreements with usage limits and audit trails. No draft text is held, and the minister described a binding regulation as the missing piece in an account given during a vendor meeting abroad.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	An AI Bill is targeted to reach parliament before December 2026, and the copyright body will not register wholly AI-generated works. The bill is announced as the statutory backing for the strategy, to establish a framework promoting innovation while safeguarding citizen privacy and ensuring operational accountability; the minister put the target at before December 2026, no draft text is stated, and the strategy it would ground is itself pre-adoption (bill , drafting , scope). The statutory copyright body will not register works created entirely by artificial intelligence or distribute royalties on them; the rule is known only as reported, with no test stated for how much assistance is admissible, and the body's own statement is not held (rule).	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE

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Data protection	Data protection authority	The authority now operates as a unit inside the regulator with a named head, draft regulations and a registration fee schedule out for consultation, and independence stated as intended. The unit has a named head of data protection and a stated implementation framework, with no organogram, enforcement record or registration data published (unit). Draft regulations, guidelines and a turnover-based registration fee schedule ranging from MWK 50,000 for small and medium enterprises to MWK 7 million for the largest controllers of significant importance were published and consulted on before finalisation (fees); no commencement date is on record (fees , consultation). The regulator states it intends to establish both the authority and the response team as independent institutions with donor technical assistance, with no legislative vehicle, timetable or funding model on record (separation); a consultancy to design the authority's structure was tendered in October 2025 with no award on file (consultancy).	ADVANCED
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	A delegation went to Accra to structure digital-government cooperation, the minister urged regional artificial-intelligence investment priorities, and the regulator opened talks with a development agency. The Accra visit was to structure cooperation under which Ghana is to make more than a dozen technology companies available to help build systems and infrastructure, with Ghana's identity card cited as the reference implementation and Malawi bringing a high-coverage identity system, a data centre and a data exchange; no memorandum, budget or timetable is named (visit). At a regional workshop in Lilongwe the minister named agriculture, healthcare, climate resilience, education, financial services and regional trade as bloc investment priorities, framing connectivity, data quality, skills and cybersecurity policy as the precondition; no bloc decision, instrument or envelope follows it (priorities). Regulator talks with a development agency named identity integration with SIM verification, responsible artificial intelligence, data protection and secondary-school skills as priorities, with no memorandum, funding figure or timetable (talks).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	A regional declaration on collaborative regulation was adopted at a Lilongwe summit in April 2026, and a regional AI framework is claimed to be under development. The declaration anchors to an international regulatory maturity framework, sets six shared principles and seven areas of collaborative action, and treats artificial intelligence, satellite, digital platforms and next-generation networks as one emerging-technology frontier; the regional association has not published the text, so the whole account is named-analyst commentary and the seven action areas are nowhere enumerated (declaration). A regional artificial-intelligence strategy and regulatory framework is reported under development with no draft, adoption date or document title beyond the name; the claim is the Malawian ministry's rather than the regional secretariat's, so any statement that the region has such a framework is unestablished (framework).	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	The country is among the fifteen participants in the regional real-time gross settlement system, which settled ZAR 218.56 billion in August 2025. The regional settlement system processed 152,660 transactions worth ZAR 218.56 billion in August 2025, an average of 5,872 a day , across fifteen participating countries and 87 participating banks including central banks. 5,478,841 transactions worth ZAR 17.56 trillion have settled since inception . The regional retail scheme running alongside it carried 248 transactions worth ZAR 322.6 million in the month across eight participants . The statistics are regional totals published by the operating central bank; no Malawian share of volume or value is broken out, so the country's own use of the system is not established.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy		NO EVIDENCE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The 2026/27 budget has no dedicated line for school internet connectivity, MWK 1.1bn for device assembly at one university, and MWK 12.4bn of the birth-registration campaign unfunded. The 2026/27 budget policy statement carries no dedicated line for school internet connectivity or digital infrastructure in primary and secondary schools; education received MWK 1.28tn, 11.7 per cent of the budget, and transport and ICT received MWK 664.4bn directed at roads, rail and aviation (budget). MWK 1.1bn was set aside for assembling laptops and tablets at the science and technology university, the nearest digital allocation to schools in that budget and directed at higher education (allocation). The birth registration campaign requires MWK 17.8bn to register about 4.6 million children across seven phases; MWK 5.4bn was allocated for phases one and two, leaving MWK 12.4bn unfunded, and the figures are the minister's rather than an appropriation document (campaign , partnership).	MIXED a device-assembly allocation and a partly funded registration campaign against no school-connectivity line at all
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	A proposed US\$180m four-year vendor investment plan is built round a one-stop government platform and a network linking all 28 districts, with no agreement made public. The roadmap was presented to the vendor in China in June 2026: a one-stop digital government platform covering passport applications, business registration and tax payments, and a high-speed network linking all twenty-eight districts with ring protection against cable failures (plan , account). Funding structure, implementation timeline and any agreements reached have not been made public, and the base holds no signed instrument, only the ministry's account of a meeting (status).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	The second mobile operator states US\$31m invested in network capacity and coverage, and a bank committed MWK 75.5m and a three-year memorandum to an innovation event. The operator's figure carries no period, site count or coverage outcome, and the commitment date is not stated (investment). A three-year memorandum commits a bank to mentorship, incubation and technical support for innovators emerging from an annual innovation event, with MWK 75,500,000 given to the 2025 edition (memorandum); the base records no outcome for any cohort, no count of ideas incubated, funded or surviving (memorandum).	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	The acceleration project runs at US\$90m on towers, data-centre upgrade and e-services, beside an inclusive transformation programme and an institutional support grant. The acceleration project was approved in June 2024 at US\$90.00m, a US\$70.00m grant plus US\$20.00m commercial financing, targeting 2,000 schools, 500 further government offices, identity enrolment and an affordable-devices programme (appraisal); procurement for more than 90 towers is being advanced, the national data centre is being upgraded to an artificial-intelligence-ready state, and 25 e-services are being onboarded (appraisal , progress). An inclusive digital transformation programme runs 2024-2028 on EUR 2,000,000 and US\$5,608,640, covering inclusive digital identity, open-source public systems and youth literacy (programme , agency record); a bilateral grant was disbursed to the same agency for the 2025 activity year (grant). An institutional support grant of XDR 10,000,000 had US\$5,591,335 disbursed at retrieval, with no event in the window on file (support).	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	An industry report puts 4G coverage at 87 per cent against mobile-internet penetration of 12.5, while 5G launched in 2025 and reached 111 sites on the other network. The industry association's report gives fourth-generation coverage at 87 per cent of the population against mobile-internet penetration of 12.5 per cent, scores the country 36 of 100 on its digital nations index and 55 of 100 on policy and regulation, and describes mobile-money adoption as near universal (report); it is the association's own index and the base holds no official national subscriber and coverage series (report). The first 5G network launched at Lilongwe in July 2025 with four further cities named as extension targets, and no later site count is held for it (launch). The other operator reported 111 sites across ten districts, after 58 new sites on MWK 50.8bn of network capital expenditure in the 2025 financial year (sites), and a fixed-wireless operator extended 4G coverage to nineteen neighbourhoods of the capital (fixed wireless).	MIXED 5G launched and expanding against fourth-generation coverage of 87 per cent that only 12.5 per cent of people use

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Connectivity	Internet usage	80 per cent of Malawians are offline despite 87 per cent fourth-generation coverage, and no state measurement is held against the target of 80 per cent usage by 2026. The appraisal document put internet use at around 24 per 100 inhabitants on a 2022 baseline against a regional average of 28 (appraisal), and a separate account put access at about 20 per cent of citizens (access). The first usable current figure comes from the operators' trade association, which puts 80 per cent of the population offline against 87 per cent coverage, so the gap is usage rather than coverage, and estimates MWK 1.1 trillion of economic value and 490,000 jobs by 2030 from closing it (report). That is a modelled figure from an interested party whose policy asks include cutting the taxes its members pay. The presidential target of 80 per cent usage by 2026 is a target and not a measurement, with no baseline given (target). A national survey published in December 2025 puts seven in ten adults as never using the internet and gives a penetration rate of 27.7 per cent, the first non-industry current measurement the base holds (survey).	NO CHANGE four fifths of the population offline with no state measurement to set against the presidential target
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	The minister called for scrapping the 10 per cent internet surtax and reviewing the 17.5 per cent smartphone value-added tax, targeting 30 per cent mobile internet usage by 2030. The call was made at a Lilongwe summit in August 2026, setting a target of raising mobile internet usage from 12.5 per cent to at least 30 per cent by 2030 (call). No budget measure, bill or instrument is on record: the treasury has published nothing and no timetable is given. It is a ministerial statement at a summit, and it is the only affordability position the base holds for the country.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	Two concessional loans financed the fibre backbone with no route length or operating status published, and procurement for more than 90 towers is advancing against a requirement above 1,000. Phase one was financed by a concessional loan of CNY 155,432,330 committed in 2016 (phase one) and phase two by CNY 693,000,000 at 1 per cent over twenty years, on-lent to the electricity utility with CNY 299,286,770 drawn as at June 2023 (phase two). The base holds the two loan records and no statement of route kilometres, completion, operator or current operating status. Tower procurement for more than 90 towers is being advanced against a project commitment of around 100, while a study cited at the same meeting puts the requirement for nationwide coverage above 1,000 towers (towers , project). A separate commercial loan covering 136 tower installations and last-mile fibre has no progress report, disbursement figure or completion statement on file (loan).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	Wholesale bandwidth fell from about US\$460 per Mbit/s a month in 2017 to below US\$10 at 2024, and no price for 2025 or 2026 is held. The fall was reported at the close of the foundations project, on the lender's own figures (close , account). No wholesale price for 2025 or 2026 is held, so whether the gain has held is not established, and a 2024 appraisal instead gives about US\$35 per Mbit/s (appraisal), which the base does not reconcile.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Thirty rural schools were connected by satellite, and an operator signalled interest in satellite backhaul at its annual meeting. Thirty rural schools were reported connected, serving 100,000 students and 1,500 teachers on a company announcement (schools); responsibility for the recurring subscription cost is not stated, and the student figure averages over 3,000 per school without reconciliation (schools , preparation). An operator signalled interest in satellite connectivity to complement terrestrial networks in hard-to-reach areas and improve resilience, with no partner, licence, capital allocation or timetable stated (interest). The base holds no satellite licence date, licence terms or subscriber figure for the country.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	A commercial data centre opened in Lilongwe in 2026 and an operator third facility passed its stated build window, against 3 per cent of content served locally. The commercial facility is in operation offering local hosting, positioned against the foreign-currency cost and data-ownership exposure of offshore hosting; capacity, tier and pricing are not stated and the account is company-reported (facility). An operator announced a third data centre for construction within three months in March 2026; that period ended in June and the base holds no record of a start, a site or a completion (third centre). A byte-weighted measurement puts 3 per cent of web content served locally and 62 per cent regionally, primarily from South Africa, the lowest local share among the economies in the study (locality); it is a single measurement on a methodology the publisher describes as under development (locality).	MIXED a first commercial facility in operation while only 3 per cent of web content is served from inside the country

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	The national data centre is the local-hosting base for the data exchange and is being upgraded, and the revenue authority has a secondary facility in service. The national facility was built in Lilongwe under the foundations project on a hyper-converged design with Blantyre as secondary and backup (construction , delivery). It now hosts the data exchange used by the revenue authority and the registration bureau, with 25 e-services being onboarded, and is being upgraded to an artificial-intelligence-ready state (upgrade , integration). No commissioning date, floor area, rack count, delivered load or tier certification is held. The revenue authority's secondary data centre is in service with power upgrades, reported as improving continuity and customs-duty accuracy at border posts and the airport, financed under a six-year regional trade project; no capacity, location or availability figure is given (secondary). The acceleration project's management plan for the government data centre states a Tier III design with uninterruptible supply, batteries, generators, cooling and fire detection, thirteen empty server racks and fifteen servers with two 42U racks installed, and a service power line still to be built (plan). It gives compute rather than electrical capacity - 277.2 GHz of processing, 2.63 TB of memory and 107.52 TB of disk - so the facility's delivered load is still not held, and the Tier III figure is a design requirement rather than a certification.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Grid reliability	The state utility publishes a rolling load-shedding programme across six groups nationwide, and an 8 per cent rise in electricity tariffs was cited by both mobile operators in support of a tariff increase. The utility publishes load-shedding as a rolling programme of downloadable schedules, organising affected areas across the Southern, Central and Northern regions into six groups, with schedules on the page running from August 2025 to one covering 23 to 27 June 2026 (programme). Scheduled disconnection is a standing condition rather than an incident; hours shed, frequency per group and any exemption for telecommunications sites or data centres are not established. An 8 per cent rise in electricity tariffs was given by the minister in Parliament alongside a roughly 144 per cent rise in fuel prices, against which the regulator approved 22.2 per cent for one mobile operator and 26 per cent for the other (figures). All those figures are the minister's, no base period is given, and no primary from the electricity regulator or utility is held.	MIXED a scheduled load-shedding regime published against a first electricity price figure
Energy	Rural electrification	An operator states it covers 85 per cent of the population and is working to reach the remaining 15 through solar-powered infrastructure. The statement was made at the operator's thirtieth-anniversary event, with no site count, capital allocation, target date or partner stated, and foreign-exchange shortages named as the operator's biggest challenge (statement). It is the only network-energy item the base holds for the country, and it is an intention rather than a programme.	ADVANCED
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	An automated human resource and payroll platform is in pilot before rollout across ministries, Parliament, the Judiciary and local councils. No supplier, cost, pilot scale or rollout date is stated, and nothing is stated on how personnel and payroll data is handled under the data protection statute (platform). It is the first government-wide administrative system in the base for the country, and it is reported from the department's own account at a meeting of heads of information technology rather than from a procurement or a project document.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	The foundations project connected some 640 government sites before closing in 2024, and the e-government department now states that over 9,000 government sites remain unconnected on ageing network infrastructure. The project closed in October 2024 with US\$72.4m committed and US\$72.6m disbursed, having delivered the national data centre, the data exchange and the first phase of e-procurement, connected some 640 government sites against a target of 400, and over 100 free public Wi-Fi spots (project); the base holds no post-closure evaluation and no independent verification of results, which are the lender's own (project). The research and education network gave over 83,000 students across 81 institutions cheaper connectivity over 2017 to 2024, and no institutional membership, bandwidth, governance or funding position has been published since project close (network , report). The e-government department states that over 9,000 government sites remain unconnected to the internet , largely because the government wide area network's infrastructure is ageing and obsolete. The acceleration project is financing a comprehensive assessment to inform a redesign of the network architecture and the procurement of replacement equipment . No total site count, assessment timetable or procurement value is stated, so the unconnected sites stand without a denominator .	MIXED a closed project's connections against 9,000 government sites still unconnected on ageing infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The response team sits inside the regulator with no incident statistics held, donor assistance was announced, and a state oil company was defrauded of K700m. The response team operates within the regulator with no establishing instrument, timetable, budget, staffing or incident statistics held; the only source is a two-paragraph trade report (team). Technical assistance covering critical-infrastructure security, legal and regulatory frameworks, data-protection systems and regional capability was outlined at a Blantyre meeting, with no amount, financing instrument, duration or workplan stated (assistance). The state oil company was defrauded of K700m after attackers hijacked email from a foreign contractor and supplied false banking details, the company instructing its bank in April 2026 to wire US\$403,605 to a fraudulent account (fraud); it attributed the control weakness to a procurement model introduced before operational and cybersecurity procedures were in place (fraud). The country is separately the only one of five studied to have rejected a foreign safe-city surveillance package (rejection).	MIXED a response team and donor assistance in place against a state company defrauded of K700m and no strategy or incident statistics at all

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The national data exchange is in use by two agencies with 25 e-services being onboarded, while the enterprise service bus is still not operating. The exchange was delivered under the foundations project and is in use by the revenue authority and the registration bureau, hosted on locally managed servers, with the immigration department integrating while retaining data ownership; being onboarded is not live, and the base holds no count of services actually in service (exchange , integration). Nothing on file establishes the service bus operating; its failure to come into service left ministries siloed and denied online passport registration and driver's licence payments, and industry voices were still pressing for all agencies to be onboarded in January 2026 (bus , pressure). Farmers across fourteen districts still use non-interoperable platforms, logging into each separately, and the harmonising framework for agricultural data remains a proposal (agriculture). A second, separately funded system is being built alongside it: two United Nations agencies and the finance ministry's economic planning department are establishing a harmonized national management information system from 2025 to 2027 on European Commission funding. No architecture, host institution or delivery milestone is stated, and nothing reconciles it with the existing exchange or the service bus.	MIXED the data exchange in use by two agencies with a third integrating while the service bus has never operated
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	Over 13.5m adults hold a national digital identity, about 99 per cent of those aged 16 and over, up from 12.5m a year earlier. The registration system has been in operation since the National Registration Act came into force in 2015, with 12.5m enrolled and links to over 33 public and private institutions recorded in May 2025 (system). The count reached over 12.8m adult identities in January 2026 (intermediate) and over 13.5m by July, about 99 per cent of the eligible population, with over 150,000 enrolled between April and June 2026 of whom 53 per cent were women (coverage , baseline). It is the highest identity coverage in this pass, and the registry's own figure is preferred over external accounts describing coverage as already complete.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	A mobile identity wallet was announced for September 2026 and a separate blockchain identity wallet is in pilot, and the base cannot establish whether they are the same product. The mobile wallet was named and announced for a September 2026 launch, complementing rather than replacing the plastic card, requiring prior registration and needing no periodic renewal; it was not live in August 2026, and rights advocates have flagged equal-access, rural-exclusion, cybersecurity and literacy caveats (wallet , launch , target). A blockchain-enabled wallet built by a development agency with an international computing centre is in pilot before nationwide rollout, with credentials to extend to birth certificates, driving licences and marriage certificates; no pilot scale, rollout date or cost is stated, and nothing is stated on how the arrangement sits under the data protection statute (blockchain , plan). Neither announcement names the other.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	Mandatory biometric SIM registration authenticates against the identity system, and no completion figure, compliance rate or closure date is held. The programme began in July 2025 with a registration window to September, run by the regulator with the registration bureau, allowing fewer than ten cards per person per operator and carrying non-compliance fines up to MWK 50,000 daily for individuals and MWK 150,000 for corporates (programme). The regulator and a development agency named integration of the identity system with SIM verification as a priority area still being explored in July 2026 (exploration), which sits awkwardly with a 2025 programme already authenticating against that system.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	A National Payments Systems Vision and Strategy 2026-2030 was launched in April 2026, above a national switch operating since 2015. The strategy prioritises infrastructure expansion and affordability for low-income users, cybersecurity and resilience to power and connectivity failure, regulatory modernisation, financial technology innovation and regional integration, with the deputy governor acknowledging persistent rural gaps; no targets, budget or milestone dates are stated and the document itself is not held (strategy). The switch has linked banks, mobile money platforms and cash machines since 2015, with an instant bank transfer service live on it from June 2025, real-time to any Malawian bank up to MWK 500m by short code (transfer , infrastructure).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	The social cash transfer programme is moving from manual cash payment to mobile money and bank transfers following a policy change. The gender and social welfare ministry is transitioning the social cash transfer programme from manual cash payment to electronic payment over mobile money and bank transfers, to reduce the security risk, operational cost and inflexibility of cash handling; the programme covers people with disabilities, parents of children and those aged 65 and over (transition). An evaluation partner's report is the held record. No share of beneficiaries on electronic payment, cost comparison, or exclusion figure for those without a phone or an account is carried in it, which in a country where a quarter of adults own a smartphone is the question the transition raises.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	A National e-Payment Gateway is designed as the single entry point for all government collections, under a fiscal governance programme of about US\$80m. The gateway was described as a 2025 breakthrough despite integration hurdles, supported by a financial inclusion project and a development bank; no live date, transaction figure or agency coverage is stated, and one dated account is all the base holds (gateway). A fiscal governance programme of SDR 60.3m, about US\$80m equivalent at appraisal, supports revenue mobilisation, budget execution and procurement modernisation including e-procurement digitalisation (programme); the base carries no implementation, disbursement or results reporting after the appraisal document (programme).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	Mobile money was integrated into the agricultural marketing corporation so farmers are paid into wallets, and card e-commerce acceptance opened to merchants. The integration lets farmers be paid directly into mobile wallets and customers pay electronically for commodities across the corporation's national market and depot network; no volume, value or farmer count is held (integration). Online acceptance of an international card scheme opened to participating merchants in August 2026, settling in local currency, dollars or both, as part of an extension to nine African markets; no Malawi-specific merchant count is given (acceptance , extension). The incumbent operator's mobile-money platform reported MK51.93bn of revenue in 2025, up 77 per cent on the year, on a stated base of more than 140,000 active agents (annual report) - its first published revenue line, with no account, transaction or value figure alongside it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Mobile money reached MWK 37.9tn in 2025, up 94 per cent, while banknote replacement is expected to cost MWK 69.8bn in 2026. Value ran at MWK 19.5tn on 1.8bn transactions in 2024 () and MWK 37.9tn on 2.4bn transactions in 2025, with subscriptions at 19.9m of which 44.8 per cent were active in a thirty-day window; airtime was 42 per cent of transactions, cash-in and cash-out 33.1 per cent and merchant payments 7.7 per cent (2025). The central bank cautions that the subscription figure counts registered wallets. Replacing worn banknotes cost MWK 50.6bn in 2025 and is expected to cost MWK 69.8bn in 2026, about 38 per cent higher (banknotes); an economists' association president named government levies on digital money transfers as a reason cash use persists (banknotes).	MIXED mobile money value up 94 per cent in a year while the cost of replacing worn banknotes rose 38 per cent
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	A regional retail payments corridor with Zambia is the first interoperable cross-border system in local currencies, with a scheme rulebook published in August 2026. The corridor links the two countries in local currencies without foreign exchange, supervised by both central banks, with three Malawian early adopters (corridor). The clearing house published the scheme rulebook setting operational and governance rules for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, alongside a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawing on research along the corridor (rulebook). No volume or value figure for the corridor is held.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	The regulator found both operators in breach of the tariff-notice requirement and ordered customer compensation, while a mobile-money interoperability order expired unreported. Both mobile operators were found in breach in respect of a notice window in mid-2026 and agreed to credit affected customers with bundles equal to the price difference by 31 July with evidence of compliance, alongside strengthened internal procedures; the approved price increase itself stands, so what was enforced is notice and not price (order , compliance , refund). The base holds no confirmation that compensation was completed. A competition order of July 2025 required a mobile-money operator to open its exclusive football ticketing platform to other providers within a year, with concurrent physical ticketing for six months and progress reports every ninety days; the compliance year expired around July 2026 and nothing held records opening, a progress report or an enforcement step (interoperability).	MIXED a tariff-notice breach enforced with customer compensation while an interoperability order's compliance year passed with nothing on file

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register	A national birth registration campaign runs seven phases across 25 districts targeting about 4.6m unregistered children, using primary schools as registration centres. The campaign's first phase was witnessed at Dedza; the bureau had registered about 3.8m children since 2015 as at January 2026 (campaign , partnership). MWK 17.8bn is required in total, MWK 5.4bn was allocated for phases one and two, and MWK 12.4bn is outstanding. No mid-campaign registration total is on record.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register	The National Addressing System Project has had nothing published about it since February 2024, and the absence of any update is itself the finding. The regulator-coordinated programme would give every property a physical address, spanning a national postcode system, addressing standards, an address database, physical infrastructure and geographic information systems (project). No completion date and no delivery figure were given then, and nothing dated after February 2024 is held, so the position is carried forward rather than re-established.	STALLED
Registries	Business register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register	6,500 electoral management devices were deployed for voter verification at the September 2025 elections, with offline glitches reported at rural polling stations. The voter register is held electronically and the devices were deployed for verification at the elections of 16 September 2025 (deployment). Two million voters had been registered using offline digital identities in 2024. The commission had refused an observer coalition electronic access to the roll in June 2025 (refusal), so the register is digital for the commission's own use and not for scrutiny of it.	ADVANCED offline failures recorded
Registries	Tax register	About 8,000 landlords were registered for rental income tax through property-registration exercises across low- and high-density areas. The drive was announced in February 2026, starting in the three main cities with data collectors recruited (announcement), and about 8,000 landlords had registered by July (progress). It is a registry drive riding on a revenue platform rather than a land registry, which is the only way a property register is being built in this base.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	The Land Information Management System has been live since February 2024, and which transactions remain on paper is still unpublished. The web-based system links lands, surveys and physical planning, allowing parcel viewing, document submission, notifications and payment of ground rent and application fees; the scope of remaining manual transactions is not published (system). The ministry convened a workflow review in August 2026 to design digital procedures for transactions still on paper; which transactions remain manual, when revised workflows will be implemented and current processing times all remain unpublished.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The health management information system is in operation but weakly used, on fieldwork across six faith-based facilities in three districts. Seventy per cent of facility respondents used the system's data against 33.3 per cent of district respondents, 31.4 per cent of facility staff had had no data-handling training in twenty-four months, supervisory visits reached under half of facilities, and there were no standard operating procedures for data management (study). The sample is six faith-based facilities in three districts rather than national, and nothing later is held, so the position is carried forward rather than re-established. The health ministry signed and issued a Digital Health Governance Framework for 2025 to 2030 in June 2025 (framework). The held capture carries the signed document's front matter and contents; its governance bodies and obligations are not read out here and no implementation report against it is held.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Education	The education partnership compact states the country already has a functional education management information system with much room for improvement, and reports its figures. The 2023-2027 partnership compact states that the country already has a functional education management information system with much room for improvement, staffed to district and zonal level by dedicated information-systems officers (compact). It reports from the system that 66 per cent of primary schools were above the pupil-to-permanent-classroom ratio in 2024, and that the primary completion rate was 48 per cent and the transition rate to secondary 47.2 per cent in 2023 (compact). The system's own coverage, update cycle and publication arrangements are not held; the figures reach the base through a donor compact rather than an education ministry release.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	A Crime Management System is in pilot, while an e-Court went live in 2024 and the traffic information system was taken back from foreign consultant control in 2026. A three-day technical training opened in Lilongwe in July 2026 ahead of a nationwide rollout (training). No procurement value, named supplier or rollout date is published, and nothing is stated on how case-file personal data is handled under the data protection statute. It is framed by the implementing partner through its governance portfolio rather than by the police. An e-Court went live in April 2024, launched by the judiciary with the police and prison services and supported by a development agency and a mobile operator, aimed at the 80 to 85 per cent of the population living beyond the reach of the formal courts, in a judiciary of 50 judges . The held record is the launch concept note, so no coverage or filing figure is established. The traffic information system, built by a South African firm and due to be handed to the road traffic directorate by 2017 , is now stated by the transport ministry to be under government control after it bypassed the foreign companies and changed the passwords . A ministry statement to a newspaper is the whole of the record: no handover instrument, settlement or audit is held for a handover nine years late.	MIXED two systems in service against a case-management pilot with no rollout date

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	The Electronic Invoicing System reached full enforcement in May 2026, with 8,552 taxpayers registered and collections above US\$28m in a month. The system was established under the amended value added tax statute, with migration off older fiscal devices required from August 2025, regulations published in January 2026, the transition period ending that month and full enforcement with penalties from 1 May 2026 after the authority rescheduled (transition , clarification). About 7,500 of roughly 9,000 registered operators had migrated by June 2026, rising to 8,552 registered by July (registered , momentum). Collections through it run at over US\$1.2m a day, with May 2026 above US\$28m (revenue); the authority collects in kwacha and the publisher gives only a dollar rendering with no rate or conversion date (revenue). The revenue authority's integrated tax administration system completed implementation in April 2025 with its audit module, the last component, strengthened by integration with a data analysis tool used by the domestic taxes division; the authority states that more than 90 per cent of large taxpayers file online while small and medium enterprises transition gradually (rollout). The compliance and efficiency gains are the authority's own characterisation, with no filing volume or processing-time figure published against them.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	A customs data exchange arrangement with South Africa was signed for real-time exchange, above a national single window launched in 2025. The arrangement establishes a secure electronic platform for real-time customs data exchange aligned to an international data model, with both authorities agreeing to fast-track implementation; no go-live date, purpose-limitation, retention or reciprocity terms are published, and the counterpart authority notified the updated arrangement and published a draft rule amendment in August 2026 (arrangement , sharing , exchange). The counterpart supplied about 18 per cent of the country's imports, US\$3bn in 2025/26, which is what makes the exchange material (window). A national single window integrating trade-related agencies launched in May 2025 and no later position is held (window).	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land	A seventeen-module agricultural information system has registered and geo-mapped 3,446,147 farming household profiles with their land parcels, alongside the land information management system. The agriculture ministry's information system is structured into seventeen modules; its farmer organisation module registered and geo-mapped 3,446,147 farming household profiles together with their land parcels in a nationwide rollout, with the registration run through a university agricultural research centre so that it was independent of the ministry (registration). The minister's statement to Parliament is the whole of the held record. No data-protection arrangement, retention rule or access policy is stated for a register geo-mapping three and a half million households. The lands ministry separately operates a land information management system (system); no parcel count, coverage figure or transaction volume for it is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	E-procurement became mandatory for all public entities in April 2026, while the passport system carries an unresolved backlog and queue transparency is only accepted in principle. The electronic procurement system built under the foundations project became mandatory nationwide from 1 April 2026 under a March directive covering all public entities, with remote submission and registration; no post-mandate uptake figure, tender count or exception list is held (mandate , initiative). A US\$29.9m passport contract awarded in January 2025 had a troubled transition and a backlog of over 100,000 applications (contract); printing resumed at Mangochi in July 2026, and a member told the House that applicants who filed nine months to a year earlier are being overtaken by same-day issuances (printing , queue). A sequence number at application, message notification and an online portal were accepted in principle and deferred until the passport system stabilises (transparency), and an electronic auctions platform is being scoped to replace paper government auctions (auctions).	MIXED e-procurement made mandatory nationwide while passport applicants who filed a year earlier are overtaken by same-day issuances

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	The first local-authority ICT policy and standards were validated in May 2026, and a successor governance project covers 32 councils to 2031. Councils had operated with no framework beyond the national digitalisation policy, a 2022 situational analysis having found weak ICT support, absent council projects and ICT excluded from procurement; the first dedicated local-authority policy plus standards were validated in May 2026 with councils being sensitised, and no adoption date is held (policy). The successor project is an SDR 58.2m grant, about US\$80m equivalent, ratified in July 2026 and closing in 2031, covering 32 councils with four entering for the first time, of which a US\$12.8m subcomponent funds business-process re-engineering, software and hardware assessments and a performance dashboard (project , appraisal). Its predecessor closed in June 2026 with its grant mechanism continuing (predecessor), so process re-engineering is funded ahead of equipment purchase.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	A real-time dashboard tracks more than 2,000 constituency projects, 27 of 28 councils qualified for performance grants, and clean audit opinions fell to 18. The dashboard was launched in July 2026 carrying project progress, budgets and locations for more than 2,000 development projects, with citizens asked to raise concerns through channels on it and named ministers given real-time access (launch); the launching minister stated its currency depends on councils uploading information manually, and no platform address is established in anything held, so none of it can be inspected (launch , dashboard , parliament , channels). Twenty-seven of twenty-eight district councils qualified for performance-based grants on the 2025/26 assessment (assessment , indicator), while councils receiving clean audit opinions fell from 22 in 2023/24 to 18 in 2024/25 with one adverse opinion (audits). A second-city council has partnered a bank to digitise revenue and tax collection, with no go-live date or collection figure held (revenue).	MIXED a real-time constituency fund dashboard launched while clean council audit opinions fell from 22 to 18
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	85 per cent of 9,000 schools have limited or no internet and about 900 have none, while a corporate programme has connected 36. Lack of electricity and of digital devices are named as the main barriers; a development bank is separately supporting connection of over 200 schools and the acceleration project targets 2,000 (analysis , targets). The corporate programme has connected 36 schools with a further nine scheduled in 2026, equipped laboratories with televisions and tablets, zero-rated twelve local learning sites and states more than 32,000 learners and over 900 teachers benefiting (programme); all figures are the company's own (programme).	MIXED a corporate programme connecting 36 schools against 85 per cent of the country's 9,000 schools with limited or no internet
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	A university commissioned an artificial-intelligence fertigation system automating irrigation and fertiliser application from real-time crop data. The system was commissioned in July 2026 at the university's Thyolo campus with an assisted smart tree nursery, under a continental agricultural-universities programme (facility). It is a single university facility rather than a national system, and no cost or funding source is stated. It is the only working sectoral use of the technology in the base for the country.	ADVANCED
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	A low-resource language data trust is assembling licensed Chichewa content as artificial-intelligence training data, with no dataset or licence terms published. The initiative was launched at a national workshop in Lilongwe in June 2026, supported by a development bank and a foundation, and is developing core frameworks alongside the content (trust). No dataset, licence terms, governance structure or release is published. A data trust holding licensed language content raises rights and consent questions the announcement does not address.	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse	The defence force intends to adopt artificial intelligence in military operations and to learn it from the Chinese army, with no doctrine, oversight body or civilian-control provision on file. The intention was stated by the defence minister at an anniversary event in Lilongwe, in a relationship stated to extend past exchanges into specialised training, equipment supply and institutional development, with further equipment, capacity building and command-level training under discussion (intention). No Malawian doctrine, oversight body, budget line or civilian-control provision for military artificial intelligence is on file, and the draft national strategy as reported does not cover it. That gap is the finding.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	Additional operator licences are under consideration, while one licensee missed a 2023 launch target and another licensed in 2022 has announced no date. The minister told Parliament that the President had authorised the ministry to identify an investor able to build a network without delay, conceding that foreign-exchange shortages constrain incumbents' equipment imports and that earlier licensees who took spectrum without launching had licences revoked, ending in litigation; no bid timetable, licence terms or spectrum allocation is stated (round , competition , pressure). One licensee targeted a late-2023 commercial launch, was delayed by macroeconomic conditions and has announced no new date (first); another licensed in 2022 has announced no launch date either (second). A third operator licensed in 2007 holds a small share available mainly in major cities and has not significantly challenged the duopoly (third).	STALLED two licensed entrants have never launched and a third has never mattered, with a new licensing round only announced
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	An operator announced artificial-intelligence laboratories and innovation hubs for 2026 with nothing opened, and a university innovation lab grant reaches its scheduled end this year. The laboratories were announced at the operator's thirtieth-anniversary event for establishment in 2026, to let Malawians build artificial-intelligence-driven services; no site, budget, partner or opening date is stated and nothing on record shows one has opened (laboratories). A grant of US\$1,880,499 committed in 2019 equips a university innovation hub for ideation, prototyping, mentorship and incubation, with a scheduled end year of 2026 and no closure or extension on file (hub); the total budget is stated as US\$3.19m against that commitment (hub). The regulator runs an information and communications technology research and innovation fund, working with 70 start-ups at the time of report in March 2024 and stating a target of 250 in the following financial year (fund). No fund size, disbursement figure or list of recipients is held, and nothing on it since. The same account names one incubator, a development agency's accelerator lab and a smart-city project near completion at Mvera, and puts venture capital at virtually non-existent; no register or directory of hubs is published by anyone.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	ICT services exports rose from about US\$70m in 2020 to US\$154m in 2023 on an industry account, while the country fell to 125th of 139 economies in the 2025 innovation index. The export series was cited by a private-sector managing director as evidence that the sector already earns foreign currency; the underlying figures are dollars, undated as to conversion, and are an industry speaker's rather than an official statistic (exports). The aggregator was founded in 2021 and offers small-business tools including interfaces, plugins, payment links, invoicing and analytics; the profile is company-reported throughout and carries no dated event, transaction volume or revenue figure (aggregator , transfers). The Global Innovation Index 2025 places the country 125th of 139 economies, 5th of the 11 low-income economies and 20th of the 32 ranked in Sub-Saharan Africa, with inputs at 122nd against outputs at 131st; it was 111th in 2020 and 107th in 2021, with no placing in 2022, 2023 or 2024, and holds no cluster in the index's top innovation clusters (index). The ranked field grew over those years, so part of the fall is a larger denominator, and the index's own confidence interval for the placing spans 23 places.	MIXED an export series and a payment aggregator against a falling innovation ranking

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)		NO EVIDENCE
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	A national survey reports a digital literacy rate of 62 per cent without naming the instrument behind it, and it is the only figure the base holds. The survey reports a digital literacy rate of 62 per cent and notes significant gender differences, alongside one of sub-Saharan Africa's lowest internet penetration rates at 27.7 per cent (survey). The figure is carried without an instrument, a definition or a measuring body being named, so what was measured is not established. No national digital literacy programme, curriculum or measurement instrument is named anywhere in the base.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	An e-learning programme for tablet-based learning centres in primary schools and teacher training colleges closed at the end of 2024 with no successor. A grant of EUR 12,996,804 committed in 2019 was almost fully disbursed at US\$14,522,971 of US\$14,549,922, and the programme closed at the end of 2024 (programme). The plan was 178 primary-school learning centres and eight mobile centres, and no delivery figure is held. No successor programme, evaluation or continuation is on file, so the country's largest school digital-learning investment ended without a published result.	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A corporate fund awarded its first 25 undergraduate places at the science and technology university, covering tuition, stipend, accommodation, data and a connectivity device. The first beneficiaries were named in August 2026, seven months after launch, drawn from seventeen districts and taking eight programmes including computer systems, cyber security, sustainable energy engineering and metallurgy (award , launch). One cohort of 25 is now filled and no continuation commitment beyond it is stated; the announced degree list at award is wider than the computing fields the launch named.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	Over 19,000 young people, 10,000 of them female, were trained through ten technology hubs to 2024, and a second entrepreneurs lab ran in Mzuzu in 2026. The training figure is cumulative over 2017 to 2024 rather than an annual rate, and no successor training count is published; the acceleration project's own training indicators are not reported in this base (training). A second edition of an artificial-intelligence and digital solutions lab trained 24 entrepreneurs from four northern districts in tools for marketing, customer engagement and financial management, under German and European programmes; no cohort total across editions, curriculum, certification or follow-up measure is stated (lab , initiative).	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	A national survey finds the gender gap in phone ownership virtually unchanged over a decade, while the Universal Service Fund is stated to be insufficiently resourced and 85 per cent of schools have limited or no internet. The fund runs a school connectivity project providing computer equipment and secondary-school skills work is stated to draw on it, but the Director General stated existing funding levels remain insufficient for the country's connectivity needs, and no income, balance or disbursement figure is held for any year (fund , skills). The regulator said in August 2026 it is evaluating fund mechanisms to subsidise consumer devices and fund digital-literacy work, including a proposed one-tablet-one-student programme (subsidies). Eighty-five per cent of the country's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none, with lack of electricity and devices the main barriers (schools , support). A December 2025 survey measures the divide the state does not: mobile-phone ownership at 66 per cent of adults, the gender gap virtually unchanged over a decade at 74 per cent of men against 57 per cent of women, and a quarter of adults owning a smartphone , with the shortfall falling hardest on rural residents, the less educated and the poor. It is a survey with a margin of two to three percentage points , not a state statistic; the state publishes none.	MIXED a universal service fund evaluating device subsidies while its own resourcing is stated as insufficient

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	A fourth national ICT survey is in the field across all districts covering 12,000 households, with its field-staff recruitment publicly questioned. The survey covers mobile and computer ownership, internet access, digital financial services, e-commerce and cybersecurity awareness, including the refugee camp at Dzaleka, run by the statistical office with the communications regulator to inform national planning; no publication date for the results is stated (survey). Field-supervisor and enumerator recruitment drew public questions when training opened in August 2026; the base holds the complaint and no response to it, and a survey whose fieldwork staffing is contested is one whose results will be read against that (recruitment).	ADVANCED
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The National Payments System Report series continues quarterly and annually, and a public sector reforms information system tracks agencies against reform targets. The payments series is in publication with the 2024 annual report reported in April 2025 (2024), a quarterly report in November 2025 (quarterly) and the 2025 annual report in March 2026 (2025); the base holds the reports only through press accounts (growth). A reforms information system launched in December 2025 as a dedicated platform tracking how agencies perform against reform targets, with no user, coverage or output figure held (reforms). Against those, the copyright levy is distributed entirely on records submitted by licensed disc-burning centres rather than on digital consumption, and tax reconciliation against a rights holder's taxpayer number is not automatic (levy).	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data	The electoral commission refused an observer coalition analysable electronic copies of the voter roll, and the same position stands after the elections. The commission held that the elections statute limits inspection to verification of entries at registration centres and regional offices; the request explicitly excluded biometric data, and the commission published the correspondence itself (refusal). Nothing held records a later request, appeal or change of practice, including after the September 2025 elections. It is the base's only recorded test of machine-readable access to a government dataset in the country.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	Two concessional loans financed the fibre backbone, the defence force intends to learn military artificial intelligence from China, and the country rejected a safe-city surveillance package. The backbone's second phase was financed at CNY 693,000,000 over twenty years, on-lent to the electricity utility with first repayment falling due in March 2027 (loan , first phase). The defence relationship is stated to extend past exchanges into specialised training, equipment supply and institutional development, with command-level training under discussion (defence). Malawi is the only one of five countries studied to have rejected the safe-city surveillance package offered by Chinese companies, and the base holds no account of who rejected it, when, or on what grounds (rejection).	MIXED concessional fibre lending and a defence artificial-intelligence relationship against a rejected surveillance package
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Delivered IT load of the national and commercial data centres	An acceleration-project procurement or supervision document, or an operator data-sheet, stating design and delivered critical load and backup generation	2026-08-30
Electrification programme for the roughly 900 schools with no connectivity	A Ministry of Education or Ministry of Energy programme document, or the 2026/27 budget detail, naming a school-electrification line with a school count and appropriation	not yet probed
Off-grid and solar powering of rural base stations under the tower programme	The regulator's tower procurement tender documents, which would state the power specification for the more than 90 sites	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Malawi Internet Exchange Point	A regulator or Internet Society record of the exchange's members, peak traffic and peering ratio; the base holds a 3% local-content figure but nothing on the interconnection layer that would explain it	not yet probed
Government cloud or shared hosting service for ministries and agencies	An e-government department service catalogue or project component report stating what the national data centre actually offers agencies and on what terms	not yet probed
Engineering and operations staffing of the regulator, the response team and the e-government department	An establishment table or annual report giving approved and filled technical posts	not yet probed
National cybersecurity strategy or policy	A published Malawi national cybersecurity strategy, or a Ministry of ICT statement confirming none exists; the base holds cybersecurity only as a component of other instruments	not yet probed
Electronic Transactions and Cyber Security Act 2016 and its enforcement record	The Act as gazetted plus any prosecution or enforcement statistics; the base cites the Communications Act 2016 repeatedly but holds nothing on Malawi's cybercrime statute	not yet probed
Incidents handled by the computer emergency response team	A response team or regulator annual report giving incidents reported and resolved by year	not yet probed
Critical information infrastructure designation	A statutory instrument or regulator notice designating critical information infrastructure and the obligations attaching to it; named as a World Bank assistance area in March 2026 with no instrument on file	not yet probed
National fibre backbone route length and operating status	A regulator sector report or ICT ministry statement giving fibre kilometres in service and the operator, against roughly US\$140m of Chinese lending committed across two phases	not yet probed
Mobile and internet subscriber and coverage series	A regulator quarterly or annual sector statistics report giving subscribers, penetration and population coverage by technology; the base has no regulator-published series for Malawi at all	not yet probed
International capacity and submarine cable landing arrangements	A record of Malawi's transit arrangements through Mozambique, Tanzania or Zambia and the cable systems they reach; Malawi is landlocked and the base says nothing about how its traffic leaves the country	not yet probed
Data localisation or residency requirement	The Data Protection Act's cross-border transfer provisions or an implementing regulation; sovereignty is the stated rationale for local hosting throughout, with no legal requirement identified	not yet probed
Death registration coverage	A registration bureau figure for deaths registered after 2025; the last held figure is under 200,000 stated at 2025-05-28 against over 3.5m births registered	not yet probed
Business and company registration system	A Registrar General statement or e-government service listing establishing whether business registration is live on the national platform; it is named only as a target in the vendor portal proposal	not yet probed
Customary land registration under the Customary Land Act 2016	A lands ministry figure for customary estates registered and district land registries operating; the only source held is a 2020 donor programme reflection reporting three district registries	not yet probed
Driver's licence online renewal	A road traffic directorate or national platform service listing; it is named as a presidential directive target and an industry association ask, with no delivery record	not yet probed
Central bank digital currency proof of concept	The National Payments Systems Vision and Strategy document itself; the held press account of the launch names no such work, and the wiki holds no central bank publication	not yet probed
National earth-observation or satellite data programme	Any dated statement from the surveys department, the meteorological department or the regulator naming a satellite data holding, ground station or earth-observation data-sharing arrangement; the base holds zero Malawi sources on this subject	not yet probed
National Statistical Office release programme	The office's published release calendar, or the census and integrated household survey report pages; no statistical office output at all is held for Malawi	not yet probed
Financial inclusion consumer survey, next round	A survey round later than the 2023 edition published August 2024; the base holds no successor and no announced fieldwork date	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Government Notice 40 of 2024, commencement of the Data Protection Act	The gazette text, which would settle whether commencement was 2 or 3 June 2024 and therefore when the general exemption elapsed	not yet probed
Access to Information Act 2017	The Act's text, the information commission's annual report, or any request-and-response record; the base names the Act once, in a 2022 essay, and holds nothing on whether it operates	not yet probed
National Statistics Act 2013	The Act's text or a statistical office statement; named once in a 2022 essay, with no position held on the statistical system's legal basis or its interaction with the Data Protection Act	not yet probed
Enforcement under the Data Protection Act 2024	A regulator enforcement register, annual report or published determination; no fine, order, breach notification, complaint or prosecution under the Act appears in anything held, more than two years after commencement	not yet probed
Regulator misinformation and disinformation tracking system	A regulator notice or procurement record establishing when the system was introduced, its legal basis and its data-handling terms; the base has only a newspaper year-review reporting its introduction in 2025	not yet probed
Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation, text	The regional regulators' association publication of the Declaration, unpublished at 2026-08-05, so a named-analyst commentary is the whole of the wiki's account and the seven action areas are nowhere enumerated	not yet probed
Ratification or transposition of AU or SADC data instruments	An instrument of ratification for the AU Malabo Convention, or a Malawian instrument transposing the AU Data Policy Framework or a regional model law; the base records only that the Data Protection Act aligns closely with the continental framework, in a third-party legal review	not yet probed
Public and parliamentary contestation of Malawi's data governance	Hansard for the sittings at which the Data Protection Act and the financing bills were debated; the base holds only two sources on this subject for Malawi, one of them a paywalled lede	not yet probed
EU-Malawi digital and data governance cooperation	Any EU-Malawi instrument text or Delegation statement addressing data governance; no Malawi source in the base carries this tag at all, and the EU material held is tagged to identity and registry subjects and says nothing about data-governance alignment or adequacy	not yet probed
United States-Malawi technology cooperation	A signed cooperation agreement, an embassy or State Department announcement, or a development finance or aid agency digital programme record naming Malawi; the base holds no United States-specific technology item for Malawi	not yet probed
Current position on the Chinese safe-city surveillance package	A government or regulator statement, or a procurement record, showing whether the 2023 rejection still stands	not yet probed
India-Malawi technology cooperation	A bilateral memorandum, Indian line-of-credit record or e-network programme document naming Malawi; nothing is held	not yet probed
Gulf state technology investment in Malawi	An investment agreement, sovereign-fund announcement or ministry statement naming a UAE, Saudi or Qatari counterparty; nothing is held	not yet probed
Adopted National AI Strategy, text and adoption instrument	The gazetted or Cabinet-approved strategy document, or a Ministry of ICT publication recording its adoption date	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence governance institution	A founding instrument or ministerial statement naming the body, its mandate and its budget line	not yet probed
Copyright society directive on AI-generated works	The body's own statement, circular or board minute stating the rule, its effective date and its test for wholly AI-generated	not yet probed
Military artificial intelligence doctrine, oversight or procurement record	A defence ministry policy, a parliamentary defence-committee record, or a procurement register entry for the defence-force training pipeline	not yet probed
ICT sector share of GDP and sector employment	A statistical office national-accounts release or a regulator sector report giving ICT value added and employment, dated	not yet probed
Official ICT services export series after 2023	A central bank balance-of-payments services table or statistical office trade-in-services release for 2024 or later	not yet probed
Count of licensed technology firms and data centre operators	A regulator licence register or Registrar General extract listing ICT operators, dated	not yet probed
Startup Act or innovation legislation	A bill, act or Cabinet paper establishing a startup registration or incentive regime; nothing of the kind is held for Malawi	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Technology hubs and incubators operating in Malawi	A directory or survey naming the hubs, their operators and their status; the base holds only one university innovation lab and one university facility	2026-08-30
Startup funding raised, deals or jobs created	A deal-tracker dataset or an association report giving dated, per-year totals for Malawian startups	not yet probed
Malawi national budget documents	The 2025/26 and 2026/27 Approved Estimates of Expenditure on Recurrent and Capital Budget, or the Budget Statement itself; there is no domestic budget archive for Malawi, so every appropriation figure held is a journalist's or minister's reading	not yet probed
Universal Service Fund accounts	A regulator annual report or fund financial statement giving levy income, balance and project disbursement; the only statement held is the Director General's remark that funding is insufficient	not yet probed
Domestic state financing of digital transformation	A Ministry of Information and Digitalization vote in the Approved Estimates; the hub's financing block records the domestic-state series as pending, so all tracked deals are external	not yet probed
The Malawi-vendor signed instrument	A signed memorandum or framework agreement; only the ministry's account of a June 2026 meeting is held, with funding structure and timeline expressly not made public	not yet probed
National digital literacy measure or programme	A statistical office or regulator household ICT-access survey reporting digital skills, or a costed national digital literacy strategy; the wiki holds zero Malawi sources on this subject	2026-08-30
National research capacity in digital technologies	A named research centre's funding line or publication record beyond the two university facilities held; no national digital research programme appears in the base	not yet probed
Acceleration project training and skills results	A project implementation status and results report against the results framework; the base holds only the appraisal targets and no reported achievement	not yet probed
Retail data and device affordability	A regulator-published tariff schedule or an affordability series; the base holds the appraisal's statement that 2GB costs almost 10% of annual gross national income per head, and nothing dated since	not yet probed
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Malawian government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.